# 1964
# Supercomputing, Moore's Law, BASIC

### April: The BASIC Language

The programming language BASIC (Beginner's All-purpose Symbolic Instruction Code) was developed by John Kemeny and Thomas Kurtz at Dartmouth College. One of the main goals of this language was to allow non-technical students to use computers. Since using a computer then usually involved writing a program, it was essential that the language be simple. The compiler was given for free by the creators which contributed to its popularity. Many flavours were created by different users, who modified the language to suit their computing knowledge, though it would still cater to beginners.

### April: IBM/360

IBM announced the first "family" of computers: the IBM/360. The series name 360 refers to the all-round compatibility of systems within the family, which meant that the data transfer did not require further processing. This was an important feature at a time when computers used proprietary standards and data transfers between them required a translation table. Unlike earlier computers that were created specifically for a particular organisation, the family concept introduced similar, basic computers that could be modified according to individual need. The /360 family included six computers, and was accompanied by over 40 peripherals that could be used with it. It was also the first computer to offer its users a guaranteed compatible upgrade option which would not need rewriting programs. To augment the /360 family, IBM also released the PL/I language compiler which could be used to create programs. The /360 family is also considered the first family of computers of the third generation, since they were entirely devoid of transistors: they used only ICs.

### April: Moore's Law

Gordon Moore made the famous statement that would be later called Moore's law. His statement was derived from his observa-